

Trip & Events App Portfolio

A ship-cash-learn roadmap: six standalone products, prioritized

Prepared for Tiziano · May 2026 · Frameworks: Weighted Scorecard, RICE, SWOT, Competitor Analysis

1. The approach

You don't want to build the whole vision in the dark. So this plan splits the travel-memory idea into six products that can each ship on their own, earn on their own, and give you a real read on demand before you commit more capital. Each product is also a deliberate stepping stone toward the integrated endgame — you release, cash, learn, and only then build the next, more expensive layer.

Two prioritization lenses are used so the ranking isn't a single opinion. A weighted scorecard tuned to your stated priorities (time-to-cash and strategic fit weighted highest, then market size) and RICE (Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort), the standard product-prioritization formula. Where they disagree, that disagreement is itself a signal — explained in Section 7.

2. Portfolio at a glance

Both frameworks independently rank SplitTrip first by a wide margin. The middle three (EventList, TripBoard, TripReel) cluster close together; TripMap ranks last in both because it is the most expensive to build and the hardest to monetize alone.

Rank	Product	Segment	Weighted /100	RICE	Build effort	Wave
1	SplitTrip	Group finance	90.0	8.53	Low	1
2	TripBoard	Travel planning	72.5	1.20	Medium	2b
3	EventList	Events / social	71.7	2.80	Low	2
3	TripReel	Memories / media	71.7	1.50	High	4
5	The Suite	Integrated platform	68.3	1.07	Very high	5
6	TripMap	Location / GIS	53.3	0.30	High	3

"Wave" is the recommended ship order (Section 7), which is not identical to raw score — it also respects dependencies (TripMap must exist before TripReel can pull route data, even though TripReel scores higher).

3. The six products

3.1. SplitTrip — Group finance (Wave 1 — the wedge)

Bill-splitting, but framed around a trip or event with a start, an end, and a guest list — not an open-ended ledger.

MVP scope (in)

- Create a trip/event; invite friends by shareable link (no account needed to join)
- Add expenses, assign who-owes-what, multi-currency entry, running balances
- “Settle up” summary and payment hand-off (link to Venmo/PayPal/bank, not in-app payments v1)
- Simple per-trip guest list (seeds EventList and the broader social graph)

Explicitly out of scope (v1)

- In-app payment processing / wallet (regulatory + cost burden)
- Receipt OCR (ship as the first paid upgrade, not in free v1)
- Itinerary, location, media — all later waves

Monetization

Freemium. Free core drives the invite-to-split viral loop; charge \$3–5/mo (or per-trip) for receipt scanning, automatic currency conversion, unlimited trips, and ad-free — the exact wall Splitwise uses, which proves the willingness to pay. Target 3–5% free → paid.

SWOT

Strengths • Trivial to build (CRUD + arithmetic) • Built-in virality: every bill drags in 3–6 friends • Recurring, real pain people already pay to solve	Weaknesses • Crowded category; hard to dethrone Splitwise • Low ARPU in this space • “Trip framing” alone is thin differentiation
Opportunities • Splitwise gates free at 3 expenses/day — a generous free tier wins switchers • Own the trip context Splitwise lacks, then expand into memories	Threats • Splitwise/Wanderlog could copy trip framing cheaply • Venmo/PayPal group features encroach

Competitive read

Splitwise leads but deliberately limits its free tier to 3 expenses/day with ads, pushing Pro at \$4.99/mo or \$49.99/yr (receipt scan, currency conversion, ad-free). Tricount, Settle Up and Splid compete on “more generous free.” Your wedge is being the trip-native, generous-free option that later does what none of them do — remember the trip.

3.2. EventList — Events / social (Wave 2)

Guest list + RSVP + countdown for parties, dinners and weddings — a top-of-funnel feeder that creates new groups.

MVP scope (in)

- Create an event page; invite by text/link; RSVP tracking with no guest account

- Countdown, co-hosts, capacity + waitlist, date polling
- One-tap “split the cost” hand-off into SplitTrip

Explicitly out of scope (v1)

- Heavy template/design library (Evite’s moat — don’t fight there)
- Ticketing/payments (that’s Eventbrite)
- Print/stationery

Monetization

Mostly free — Partiful has made free table stakes. Monetize only the high-value subset: premium/branded wedding pages, custom domains, or a one-time fee for keepsake event pages. Treat EventList primarily as a cheap user-acquisition feeder for SplitTrip and the trip graph, not a standalone profit center.

SWOT

Strengths • Cheap to build • Natural feeder: events create groups that then split bills • Viral by nature (every invite is a referral)	Weaknesses • Almost impossible to charge for the core • Partiful is free, polished and VC-funded
Opportunities • Weddings/keepsakes are a paying niche Partiful ignores • Bridge events → trips inside one graph	Threats • Partiful or Evite add bill-splitting • Platform-native invites (Apple/Google) improve

Competitive read

Partiful is free, ad-free and backed by ~\$27M (a16z-led), already bundling RSVP, text blasts, photo albums and payment collection — with no paid tier yet. Evite monetizes premium invites at \$17.99–\$99.99/event and Evite Pro at \$249.99/yr. Lesson: don’t monetize the invite; monetize the keepsake and use events to grow the network.

3.3. TripBoard — Travel planning (Wave 2b)

Real-time collaborative itinerary plus shared checklists (packing, who-brings-what) — the layer that makes the app daily-active during a trip.

MVP scope (in)

- Real-time collaborative day-by-day itinerary
- Shared lists/checklists with assignments
- Map of saved places; links from SplitTrip expenses to itinerary items

Explicitly out of scope (v1)

- AI suggestions/auto-planning (a “nice plus” at most, never a dependency)
- Flight/hotel inbox parsing (TripIt’s domain)
- Booking/affiliate engine

Monetization

\$30–40/yr Pro, mirroring Wanderlog's proven \$39.99/yr — but only once collaboration is genuinely sticky. Until then keep it free to build engagement.

SWOT

Strengths • Drives daily engagement during the trip • Collaboration creates lock-in for the group	Weaknesses • Real-time sync adds real build cost • Wanderlog already does collab itinerary + budget + splitting
Opportunities • Bundle itinerary + bills + memories where Wanderlog has no memory layer • Engaged trip users are the audience for the recap upsell	Threats • Wanderlog is a strong, cheap, well-loved incumbent • Google Travel / Maps lists encroach

Competitive read

Wanderlog Pro (\$39.99/yr) already offers real-time collaborative editing, shared budgets and expense splitting — the strongest incumbent here. Triplt Pro (\$49/yr) only organizes existing bookings with read-only sharing. Push TripBoard only if your trip users show real daily engagement; otherwise it's a feature, not a product.

3.4. TripMap — Location / GIS (Wave 3)

Opt-in group live location plus the ability to pin and tag special places — the layer that quietly captures the raw material for memories.

MVP scope (in)

- Opt-in, privacy-first live location sharing within a trip group
- Auto-log of places visited; manual pin + tag + note a “special place”
- Offline capture, sync later (essential while traveling)

Explicitly out of scope (v1)

- Always-on tracking by default (privacy non-starter)
- Standalone sale — this is a bundled capability, never a separate paid app
- Social map / public discovery

Monetization

Not sold standalone. Bundled into Pro. Its job is to capture the route + pinned places that make the Wave-4 recap possible; charging for it directly would lose to free platform tools.

SWOT

Strengths • Captures the unique data the recap is built from • Pins + tags add emotional context competitors lack	Weaknesses • Battery, privacy, real-time infra = real cost • Weak willingness to pay on its own
Opportunities • Privacy-first, trip-scoped sharing is differentiated from always-on trackers	Threats • Life360 and Apple Find My own location sharing for free • Privacy backlash / OS permission tightening

Competitive read

Location sharing is dominated by free, platform-level tools — Apple Find My and Life360 — and Zenly (the beloved social-location app) was shut down, showing standalone location apps struggle. So TripMap is explicitly a supporting layer: build it only after Waves 1–2 prove retention, keep it opt-in, and let it feed the recap rather than trying to win location sharing.

3.5. TripReel — Memories / media (Wave 4 — the payoff)

Photos and videos pinned to the trip map, stitched into an auto-generated recap video — the emotional climax and the growth engine.

MVP scope (in)

- Attach photos/videos/notes to pinned places and days
- Auto-build a route-animated highlight reel at trip's end
- One-tap share of the recap (this is the marketing loop)

Explicitly out of scope (v1)

- Heavy in-app editor (keep templated/automatic)
- AI auto-curation — a later “nice plus,” not required for v1
- Social feed / public profiles

Monetization

Highest-margin wave. One-time recap unlock and/or printed photo book — the proven Polarsteps model (books from €36). Charge at the emotional peak (trip's end) when willingness to pay is highest, and let every shared recap recruit new users for free.

SWOT

Strengths • Strong, proven willingness to pay at the emotional peak • Shared recaps are the cheapest possible acquisition • Highest strategic fit — it is the vision's payoff	Weaknesses • Video rendering, storage and media pipeline are costly • Long path before this wave can ship
Opportunities • No bill-splitter offers memories; no memory app offers bills — you own the loop • Physical books = high-margin one-time revenue	Threats • Polarsteps, Relive and a new “TripReel” app already exist • Google Photos “Memories” is free and automatic

Competitive read

The endgame is validated and contested. Polarsteps (free app) monetizes printed travel books (€36–€150) and a yearly “Unpacked” recap; Relive turns GPS routes into 3D flyover videos, free with a €6.99/mo Plus tier; an app literally named “TripReel” is already on the App Store. Note the name conflict — you'll need a different brand. Your edge isn't a better recap in isolation; it's that the recap is fed by the bills, itinerary and map already in one app.

3.6. The Suite — Integrated platform (Wave 5 — the endgame)

The all-in-one trip super-app: plan, split bills, share location, capture memories, and relive it — one group, one app, one loop.

MVP scope (in)

- Unifies all prior modules under one trip object and one group
- Single Pro bundle across modules
- Cross-module intelligence (e.g., expenses auto-pin to places on the map)

Explicitly out of scope (v1)

- Building before each module has proven demand independently
- Trying to win every segment head-on simultaneously

Monetization

Single Pro subscription plus high-margin one-time recap/book sales — multiple revenue streams over the same user base. Only assemble once the pieces have each earned their place.

SWOT

Strengths • Defensible: no incumbent owns the whole trip loop • Multiple revenue streams over one acquired user • Compounding network effects from every prior wave	Weaknesses • Most expensive and slowest to build • Highest execution and focus risk
Opportunities • Own “the trip” end-to-end where rivals own only one slice	Threats • A well-funded incumbent (Wanderlog, Splitwise) bundles first • Scope creep dilutes quality across modules

Competitive read

No competitor currently spans the full loop: Splitwise has bills but no memories; Polarsteps has memories but no bills; Wanderlog has planning + splitting but no recap; Partiful has events only. The Suite is defensible precisely because assembling the whole loop — funded incrementally by each prior wave — is what none of them have done.

4. Competitor landscape by segment

Current pricing and positioning (May 2026). Sources listed in Section 8.

Segment	Key players	Pricing	Your angle
Bill splitting	Splitwise, Tricount, Settle Up, Splid	Splitwise free (3/day cap); Pro \$4.99/mo or \$49.99/yr	Trip-native + generous free; later: the only one that remembers the trip
Trip planning	Wanderlog, Triplt	Wanderlog Pro \$39.99/yr; Triplt Pro \$49/yr	Bundle planning with bills + memories (Wanderlog has no memory layer)
Event / RSVP	Partiful, Evite, Paperless Post	Partiful free; Evite premium \$17.99–\$99.99/event, Pro \$249.99/yr	Don't monetize invites — use them to grow the group graph; charge on keepsakes
Location sharing	Apple Find My, Life360 (Zenly shut down)	Free / platform-owned	Don't compete; offer opt-in, trip-scoped sharing as a feeding layer
Memories / recap	Polarsteps, Relive, TripReel	Polarsteps books €36+; Relive Plus €6.99/mo	Recap fed by your own bills + itinerary + map = a loop none of them close

5. Strategic synthesis

The crowded, low-margin end (bill splitting) is your cheapest, fastest entry and your viral engine. The expensive, high-margin end (memories/recap) is your payoff and growth loop — but you only earn the right and the cash to build it after the wedge proves people stick. The genuine white space is the full loop: every incumbent owns exactly one slice, and assembling the whole thing incrementally is the defensible move.

Critically, none of these products depends on AI. AI is at most a “nice plus” later — auto-curating recap clips, suggesting itinerary items, or categorizing expenses — never a build dependency or a reason for the product to exist.

6. SWOT and RICE — how to read them together

SWOT (per product, Section 3) is qualitative: it tells you why a product wins or loses and where the risks sit. RICE and the weighted scorecard are quantitative rankers. Use SWOT to decide how to play a product, and the scores to decide which to build first.

7. Recommended ship sequence — and why the rankings differ

The weighted model and RICE agree on SplitTrip at #1 and TripMap at last, but they disagree in the middle. RICE pushes EventList up (cheap, broad reach) and pushes TripReel/TripBoard down (high effort hurts the $\div$ Effort term). The weighted model lifts TripReel because you weighted strategic fit highly. Both are “right” — RICE optimizes for efficient near-term wins; your weights optimize for the long-term vision. The sequence below honors both, plus build dependencies.

Wave 1 — SplitTrip

Weeks 1–4. Ship the wedge, turn on the paid upgrade early, watch invite-activation and free → paid. This funds everything else.

Wave 2 — EventList

Weeks 5–8. Cheap feeder that creates new groups; keep core free, test keepsake/wedding monetization.

Wave 2b — TripBoard

Weeks 7–12. Add collaborative itinerary to lift daily engagement; only push Pro if engagement is real (Wanderlog is strong).

Wave 3 — TripMap

Months 4–6. Opt-in location + place pins. Bundled, not sold alone. Built now because Wave 4 needs its data.

Wave 4 — TripReel

Months 6–9. The recap payoff and viral loop; monetize via one-time unlock and printed books at the emotional peak.

Wave 5 — The Suite

Months 9+. Assemble the full loop into one Pro bundle once each module has independently proven demand.

Kill/Go signals for each wave are in the “Build Sequence” tab of the companion spreadsheet.

8. Sources

[Splitwise pricing \(Free vs Pro\), 2026](#)

[Polarsteps — travel book pricing](#)

[Polarsteps — plan, track, relive](#)

[Partiful vs Evite \(2026\)](#)

[Partiful \(free invitations\)](#)

[Wanderlog vs Triplt pricing \(2026\)](#)

[Relive — route recap videos / pricing](#)

[TripReel — existing App Store listing](#)